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Google Ads Campaign Strategy

UBIS Global — ABD & Masters Transfer Pathways

Long-tail keyword strategy to avoid expensive head terms

Target CPC: \$1.50–\$4.00 | Budget: \$3,000/month

ubisglobal.com

Campaign Overview

Core Strategy

Drive qualified prospects to ABD and Masters transfer landing pages at the lowest possible cost per click by targeting long-tail, high-intent keywords that competitors ignore.

Avoid head terms like "MBA online," "DBA program," or "masters degree." These cost \$15–50+ per click. Instead, target the specific pain points and situations of people who are already past the research phase and looking for a solution.

Two campaigns, two landing pages:

Campaign	Landing Page	Daily Budget	Target CPC
ABD Dissertation Completion	abd.html	\$30–50/day	\$1.50–\$4.00
Masters Credit Transfer	masters.html	\$30–50/day	\$1.50–\$4.00

Campaign 1: ABD Dissertation Completion

Keyword Group A — "ABD" Specific (Highest Intent)

These people know exactly what their situation is. Low competition, high conversion.

Keyword	Match Type	Est. CPC
ABD completion program	Phrase	\$2–4
all but dissertation help	Phrase	\$1.50–3
finish my dissertation	Phrase	\$2–5
ABD to doctorate	Exact	\$1–3
ABD pathway	Phrase	\$1–2
complete my dissertation online	Phrase	\$3–6
dissertation completion program	Phrase	\$3–5
finish my DBA	Phrase	\$2–4
stuck on dissertation	Broad modifier	\$1–3
can't finish dissertation	Broad modifier	\$1–2

Keyword Group B — Problem / Pain Keywords

These people are frustrated but may not know ABD is the term for their situation.

Keyword	Match Type	Est. CPC
dissertation help for doctoral students	Phrase	\$2–4
dissertation coaching online	Phrase	\$3–6
dissertation support program	Phrase	\$2–4
how to finish a dissertation	Phrase	\$1–3
dissertation writing support	Phrase	\$3–5
doctoral dissertation help	Phrase	\$2–4
abandoned my dissertation	Broad modifier	\$1–2
lost my dissertation advisor	Broad modifier	\$1–2
dissertation mentor	Phrase	\$2–4
dissertation accountability partner	Phrase	\$1–3

Keyword Group C — Transfer / Completion Keywords

People looking to finish a degree they started elsewhere.

Keyword	Match Type	Est. CPC
transfer doctoral credits	Phrase	\$2–4
finish doctoral degree started elsewhere	Phrase	\$1–3
complete DBA from another school	Phrase	\$2–4
doctoral degree completion online	Phrase	\$3–5
transfer PhD credits to DBA	Phrase	\$2–4
finish PhD coursework already done	Phrase	\$1–3
doctoral advanced standing	Phrase	\$1–2

Ad Copy — ABD Campaign

AD 1 — ABD-SPECIFIC

Headline 1: ABD? Finish Your DBA

Headline 2: Structured Dissertation Support

Headline 3: ~1 Year to Completion

Description 1: 4 faculty-guided tracks. Rotating mentors from top institutions. No coursework repetition.

Description 2: From \$800/track. Weekly intakes. IACBE-accredited. See your cost today.

Display path: ubisglobal.com/ABD-Pathway

AD 2 — PAIN-FOCUSED

Headline 1: Stuck on Your Dissertation?

Headline 2: You're Not Alone. We Help.

Headline 3: Finish in About 1 Year

Description 1: 76% of ABD candidates never finish. Don't be one of them. Structured support, rotating faculty.

Description 2: Transfer your existing credits. No repetition. See exactly what you'll pay.

Display path: ubisglobal.com/Finish-DBA

AD 3 — COST-FOCUSED

Headline 1: Finish Your DBA for Less

Headline 2: \$800 Per Dissertation Track

Headline 3: Transfer Your Credits

Description 1: 4 structured tracks. Rotating faculty from Harvard, Stanford, Oxford-level institutions.

Description 2: Use the calculator to see your exact cost. Free credit evaluation. Start this week.

Display path: ubisglobal.com/DBA-Cost

Negative Keywords — ABD Campaign

Block these to prevent wasted spend:

free dissertation template · dissertation topics · dissertation examples · dissertation format · dissertation outline generator · cheap dissertation writing service · buy dissertation · dissertation writing service · hire someone to write dissertation · phd stipend · phd funding · phd scholarships · dissertation software · dissertation latex · dissertation formatting service

Campaign 2: Masters Credit Transfer

Keyword Group A — Transfer-Specific (Highest Intent)

Keyword	Match Type	Est. CPC
transfer graduate credits	Phrase	\$2–4
transfer masters credits	Phrase	\$2–4
how many credits can I transfer masters	Phrase	\$1–3
transfer credits to finish masters	Phrase	\$2–4
masters degree credit transfer	Phrase	\$2–4
graduate credit transfer policy	Phrase	\$1–3
transfer MBA credits	Phrase	\$3–5
transfer MAIR credits	Phrase	\$1–2
international credit transfer masters	Phrase	\$2–4
accept transfer credits online masters	Phrase	\$2–4

Keyword Group B — Completion / Finish Keywords

Keyword	Match Type	Est. CPC
finish my masters degree	Phrase	\$2–4
complete my masters online	Phrase	\$3–5
finish my MBA online	Phrase	\$4–7
complete MBA started elsewhere	Phrase	\$2–4
finish masters degree fast	Phrase	\$2–4
how to finish my masters degree	Phrase	\$1–3
incomplete masters degree	Broad modifier	\$1–2
went back to finish my masters	Broad modifier	\$1–2
return to finish masters	Broad modifier	\$1–2

Keyword Group C — Speed / Cost Keywords

Keyword	Match Type	Est. CPC
fastest way to get a masters	Phrase	\$2–4
cheapest way to finish masters	Phrase	\$2–4
affordable masters degree completion	Phrase	\$3–5
masters degree in 8 weeks	Phrase	\$2–4
accelerated masters program online	Phrase	\$4–7
one term masters completion	Phrase	\$1–3
finish masters in one semester	Phrase	\$2–4

Keyword Group D — International Student Keywords

Keyword	Match Type	Est. CPC
transfer international credits to US masters	Phrase	\$1–3
foreign credits US masters degree	Phrase	\$1–3
international student finish masters US	Phrase	\$2–4
overseas masters credits transfer	Phrase	\$1–2
UK masters credits transfer US	Phrase	\$1–3
european credits US masters	Phrase	\$1–2

Ad Copy — Masters Campaign

AD 1 — TRANSFER-FOCUSED

Headline 1: Transfer Up to 70% of Credits

Headline 2: Finish Your Masters Fast

Headline 3: From Under \$2,700

Description 1: 2-3x the industry transfer norm. Take 3 courses at once. Finish in 8 weeks.

Description 2: Use our calculator to see exactly what transfers and what you'll pay. Free evaluation.

Display path: ubisglobal.com/Transfer-Credits

AD 2 — SPEED-FOCUSED

Headline 1: Finish Your Masters in 8 Weeks

Headline 2: 3 Courses. One Term. Done.

Headline 3: Transfer Your Existing Credits

Description 1: Take all remaining classes simultaneously. Weekly intakes. No waiting for semesters.

Description 2: IACBE-accredited. 40+ nationalities. See how fast you can finish with our calculator.

Display path: ubisglobal.com/8-Week-Masters

AD 3 — COST-FOCUSED

Headline 1: You Already Paid for the Credits

Headline 2: Don't Pay for Them Again

Headline 3: Transfer Up to 70%

Description 1: The highest transfer ceiling in the market. From \$2,700 out-of-pocket to finish.

Description 2: International credits accepted. Free transcript evaluation. Calculate your cost now.

Display path: ubisglobal.com/Dont-Pay-Again

AD 4 — INTERNATIONAL-FOCUSED

Headline 1: Foreign Credits? US Degree.

Headline 2: Transfer International Credits

Headline 3: Finish Your Masters Here

Description 1: We evaluate transcripts from universities worldwide. Up to 70% transfer accepted.

Description 2: IACBE-accredited. Washington DC. 100% online. See what your credits are worth.

Display path: ubisglobal.com/International-Transfer

Negative Keywords — Masters Campaign

Block these to prevent wasted spend:

free masters degree · masters scholarship · masters funding · masters grant · student loans
masters · FAFSA · how to apply to masters · masters application requirements · masters degree
requirements · what is a masters degree · masters vs phd · masters degree salary · online
masters no experience · free online courses · coursera · udemy · edx

Campaign Settings

Location Targeting

- **Primary:** United States
- **Secondary** (separate campaigns, lower bids): UK, Canada, Australia, Nigeria, India, UAE, Saudi Arabia
- For international, use the international keyword groups only

Ad Schedule

- Run 24/7 initially
- After 2 weeks, review conversion data and reduce bids during low-conversion hours (typically 1am–6am in target time zones)

Device Bidding

- Start with equal bids across devices
- Desktop typically converts better for higher-education decisions; consider +10–15% bid adjustment after data accumulates

Audience Targeting (Observation Mode)

Add these as observation audiences to learn who converts, then bid adjust:

- In-market: "College & University"
- In-market: "Business Education"
- Affinity: "Avid Investors" (for DBA)
- Affinity: "Business Professionals"
- Custom intent: people searching for "dissertation help" or "finish my degree"

Budget Allocation

Campaign	Daily Budget	Monthly	Priority
ABD — Group A (ABD-specific)	\$20	\$600	Highest
ABD — Group B (Pain)	\$15	\$450	High
ABD — Group C (Transfer)	\$10	\$300	Medium
Masters — Group A (Transfer)	\$20	\$600	Highest
Masters — Group B (Completion)	\$15	\$450	High
Masters — Group C (Speed/Cost)	\$10	\$300	Medium
Masters — Group D (International)	\$10	\$300	Medium

Recommendation

Start with \$50/day total and scale the best performers. Group A keywords in both campaigns should get the most budget — they have the highest intent and lowest CPC.

Conversion Tracking

Set up these conversion events:

Event	Type	Notes
Calculator interaction	Micro-conversion	User adjusts calculator inputs. High volume, fast optimization signal.
CTA button click	Primary conversion	"Start Your Application" / "Get Free Evaluation"
Time on page > 60s	Secondary signal	Engaged visitor, useful for audience building

Use Google Ads conversion tracking or Google Tag Manager. The calculator interaction is your highest-volume signal and will optimize the algorithm fastest.

Why This Strategy Works

1

Long-tail keywords cost 5–10x less than "MBA online" (\$3 vs \$30+)

2

Higher intent — someone searching "ABD completion program" is further along than "what is an MBA"

3

Low competition — most universities bid on head terms; almost nobody bids on "finish my dissertation"

4

Landing page match — each keyword group maps directly to page content, improving Quality Score and lowering CPC further

5

Negative keywords — aggressively filtering out freebie-seekers and researchers who will never convert

Quick Start Checklist

- ☐ Create Google Ads account (or use existing)
- ☐ Set up conversion tracking on both landing pages
- ☐ Launch Campaign 1 (ABD) with Group A keywords only
- ☐ Launch Campaign 2 (Masters) with Group A keywords only
- ☐ Add all negative keyword lists
- ☐ Set location targeting to US only initially
- ☐ Run for 2 weeks, review search terms report
- ☐ Add converting search terms as new keywords

- Add non-converting search terms as negatives
- Scale budget on best-performing ad groups
- Expand to Group B and C keywords once data is solid